user	content	timestamp	retweets	favorites
Al	I really love seafood.	Mon Dec 23 2013 21:30	Raj,Pris,Roy	Sam
Al	I take that back, this	Mon Dec 23 2013 21:55	Roy	
Al	From now on, I'm only	Mon Dec 23 2013 22:22		Roy,Sam
Roy	Great workout!	Mon Dec 23 2013 7:20		
Roy	Spectacular oatmeal!	Mon Dec 23 2013 7:23		
Roy	Amazing traffic!	Mon Dec 23 2013 7:47		
Roy	Just got a ticket for	Mon Dec 23 2013 8:05		Sam,Sally,Pris
Pris	Going to have some boiled	Mon Dec 23 2013 18:23		Sally
Pris	Maybe practice some	Mon Dec 23 2013 19:47		Sally
Sam	@Roy Let's get lunch	Mon Dec 23 2013 11:05	Pris	Sally,Pris

Figure 8.3 Our improved spreadsheet built with `<div>` elements. You can see how each div is the same width. Because of our overflow settings, it displays as much of the text as it can.

This code has some obvious oversimplifications. As shown in figure 8.3, it doesn't make much sense to have each column the same width. Although we could create a method for measuring the maximum size of the text in that field, that's not where we'll go in this chapter. I want to show a general overview of manipulating elements like these rather than create the ultimate D3 spreadsheet.

8.2.3 Animating our spreadsheet

It's time now to add interactivity to the static chart shown in figure 8.3. One traditional interaction technique applied to spreadsheets is the ability to sort them. We can do that with our spreadsheet by sorting the data and rebinding it to the cells, just like we did previously with SVG elements. By tying this to the same `transition()` behavior we used before, we can also animate that sorting.

Listing 8.5 Sorting functions

```
d3.select("#traditional").insert("button", ".table")
          .on("click", sortSheet).html("sort");
d3.select("#traditional").insert("button", ".table")
          .on("click", restoreSheet).html("restore");

function sortSheet() {
     var dataset = d3.selectAll("div.datarow").data();
     dataset.sort(function(a,b) {
          var a = new Date(a.timestamp);
          var b = new Date(b.timestamp);
```

Simple controls for our spreadsheet

Casts as date and sorts the array so that earlier tweets are lower in the array